DEREGULATION SCORECARD

How Modi's biggest deregulation drive is cutting red tape, scrapping outdated rules and freeing businesses across five categories in all states and Union Territories

TOTAL ACTIONABLE REFORMS 828
23 priority areas in each of the 36 states/UTs

IMPLEMENTED	630 (76%)
UNDER IMPLEMENTATION	79 (10%)
NOT IMPLEMENTED / NA	119 (14%)

LAND USE

Bottlenecks: Rigid land-use zoning requiring extra approvals is reducing land efficiency

- Change of land use approvals requiring enormous documentation
- Absence of marked available industrial land raising search time
- Mandatory open areas or 'setback rules' making use of factory/ commercial plots untenable

Reforms: Permitting mixed-use development

- Simplifying paperwork by enabling online applications
- Creating industrial land databanks
- Amend building regulations to reduce land loss

79% 13% 8%

CONSTRUCTION

Bottlenecks: Government-only inspections slowed building approvals

- Completed buildings sat idle, waiting for occupancy certificates
- Utility/ groundwater permissions took forever
- Frequent demand for fire NOCs

Reforms: Increased role of empanelled third-party inspectors in granting approvals

- Simplifying occupation certificates
- Online application for electricity/ water compliances
- Allowing third party fire inspections

83% 11% 6%



50%
STATES & UTs have removed prohibition on women working in 'hazardous' industries after instituting safeguards

35
STATES & UTs out of the 36 have moved electricity, water and groundwater compliances to online application, tracking and payments

missions. The key objectives were to identify redundant, overlapping or outdated compliances and rationalise them.

As part of the second prong of the strategy, Modi turned the spotlight to the central government's thicket of regulations, certifications, licences and permissions. In her budget speech on February 1, 2025, Union finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman announced the setting up of a High-Level Committee on Non-Financial Regulatory Reforms (HLC-NFRR) to tackle regulatory issues pertaining to the Union government. The committee was constituted on August 19, 2025, with NITI Aayog member and former cabinet secretary Rajiv Gauba heading it to usher in what Modi in his Independence Day speech four days earlier had termed "next generation reforms".

Gauba constituted 11 working groups, covering areas from deregulation and decriminalisation to environmental regulation,

"THE NEW RULES MARK A PARADIGM SHIFT FROM BEING PROHIBITED UNLESS PERMITTED TO BEING PERMITTED UNLESS PROHIBITED"



– RAJIV GAUBA
Chairperson, High-Level Committee on Non-Financial Regulatory Reforms